PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

May 14, 2026
Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, 501 N. Dixon Street, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendees:

Committee Members: Rashelle Chase-Miller (Committee Chair); Christy Splitt; Virginia La Forte; Eve Thompson (District Student Council Representative)

Other Attendees: Stephanie Engelsman - Board Member; Jey Buno - Chief of Student Supports; Kimberlee Armstrong - Superintendent; Mary Kane - Senior Legal Counsel; Deborah Kafoury - Chief of Staff; Korinna Wolfe - Senior Director, Multiple Pathways; Sunita Sunoz - Director, Charter Schools; Renard Adams - Chief Accountability and Equity Officer; Kristen Moon - Director, Teacher Professional Learning Department; Russell Adamson - Senior Director, Technology & Digital Transformation; Loretta Benjamin-Samuels - Senior Director, Professional Learning and Leadership; Melissa Lim-Learning Technologies Program Administrator; Ryan Hoxie - IT Training Consultant

Call to Order and Introductions

Committee Chair Chase-Miller called the meeting to order at 4:36 pm.

Public Comment

- Beth Cavanaugh - Expressed concerns about the impact of Senate Bill (SB) on electives.
- Erika Freundlich - Provided comments on the Social Studies Curriculum that is being considered for adoption and the reference to the history of Israel, and urged the Committee to consider McGraw Hill as an alternative.
- Katharine Young- A member of the curriculum selection committee would like to have clear content searchability prior to the final adoptions.

Annual Charter School Report

Korinna Wolfe and Sunita Sandoz presented the Annual Charter School Report and shared that Kairos PDX is on an Improvement Plan due to low performance. They shared that Kairos now has new leadership and this should help them stabilize. There were questions about their staffing, Special Education Services, and what statutory requirements the sponsor district needs to follow. There were questions about the pass-through rates for state funding.

Interim Assessment Tool Selection Update

Renard Adams presented an update on the District's selection of a new interim assessment tool, Curriculum Associates' iReady. Committee members raised questions about family outreach for feedback, the difference between norm- and standards-based reporting, the definition of computer-adaptive testing, and the distinction between achievement and growth measures. Members also expressed concern about the added instructional and screen time required with the assessment, and stated a need to continue monitoring OSAS outcomes.

6-12 Social Studies Instructional Resource Recommendation

Filip Hristic presented the recommendation resulting from the District's 6-12 social studies curriculum adoption process. Staff recommend TCI for grades 6-8, based on strong student and teacher feedback, and a combination of Savvas/National Geographic and TCI for grades 9-12. There were questions about whether the curriculum adequately covers current events, and a request for more detailed high school teacher feedback data. The Committee recommended forwarding the curriculum to the full Board.

Artificial Intelligence in Portland Public Schools

Loretta Benjamin Samuels, Melissa Lim, Russel Adamson, and Kristen Moon, presented a progress update on the District's AI planning work, which covered the District's AI readiness assessment, an AI vision statement developed with parent and educator input, a living "AI guidebook," and the decision to adopt Google Gemini as the District's governed AI tool. They also shared results of a new student AI perception survey conducted with Panorama.

Committee members raised questions about the "profile of an AI-ready graduate" framework, the appropriateness of AI tools for elementary-age students, and the low response rate to the survey. There was also an expressed desire to slow down until staff and educators feel ready. Committee members asked that future updates to the Board include input from the Climate Crisis Response Committee and consideration of related policy updates.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

Committee members were asked to email Chair Chase-Miller with topics for future meetings.

Adjourn

Committee Chair Chase Miller adjourned the meeting at 6:48 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell

Senior Board Manager / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools
